

Launch an AI-Run Company in a Weekend

Half a million AI-run companies have been launched this year and almost none of them sell anything. This is the weekend plan that fixes that: validate first, then pick the platform, then brief the agents. No code. One idea. Two days.

The one-liner

Any of the autonomous-company platforms will build you a live business in twenty minutes. None of them will find out whether anyone wants it. This guide puts the finding-out first, then the building, so that by Sunday night you have a company that is either selling or is a cheap, fast, honest failure.

The platforms' own numbers explain why the order matters. Polsia's founder says one company in ten on his platform has earned a dollar. NanoCorp publishes its leaderboard and the top company is in the low thousands. The agents build fine. The gap is demand, and demand is the part you do on Saturday.

By the numbers — September 2026

~6%

of the half-million companies created on Polsia are still active

1 in 10

has ever earned a dollar, per Polsia's founder

20 min

from one sentence to a live site, app, domain and Stripe account on NanoCorp or Polsia

\$20–30

the entry price on either managed platform; Paperclip is free plus model usage

5

real conversations with potential customers this guide asks for before you build anything

7 days

how long to give the launched company before deciding to double down or kill it

Saturday — validate before you build

The whole weekend hinges on Saturday. Skip it and you are the factory worker in the Rest of World story: a polished company, fabricated reviews, ad spend, zero customers.

Morning — pick one problem, not one idea

Write down a problem a specific kind of person has, that they already spend money or real time on. Not "an app for dog owners." Instead: "small dog groomers lose bookings because they answer the phone between clients." The narrower the person, the easier the next two steps.

Two tests before you continue. Can you name five real people who have it? Would they pay \$20 a month, or \$100 once, to make it go away? If either answer is no, pick another problem. This step should take an hour and it is where most weekends should end.

Midday — talk to five people

Message five people who have the problem. Not friends being kind — people in the group. A forum, a Facebook group, a subreddit, a WhatsApp community, a trade association, a LinkedIn search. Ask three things: how do you handle this now, what does it cost you, what have you tried. Do not pitch. Listen for the words they use; you will give those words to the agents on Sunday.

Three of five say it is a real pain and describe what they do about it: continue. Fewer: change the problem, not the plan.

Afternoon — write the one-page brief

Everything the agents will need, in plain English, in the customer's own words:

- **Who** — the person, precisely. "Independent dog groomers in the US with one to three staff."
- **Problem** — in their words, from the calls.
- **Offer** — the smallest thing that solves it. One feature, not a platform.
- **Price** — the number you tested. If you did not test one, \$29 a month or \$49 once are safe starting points for a small-business tool.
- **Proof** — one line about why you, or why now.
- **Not this** — three things the agent must not do: no fabricated testimonials, no cold email to people who did not opt in, no spend above the cap.

Evening — the pre-sale test

Before any platform, put up the cheapest possible test: a single page with the offer, the price and a button. A free page builder, a Stripe payment link, or even a Google Form that says "reserve your spot." Send it to the five people and to the group you found them in. If two people click through to pay or reserve by Sunday morning, you have a business worth building. If nobody does, you have saved a month.

Sunday — choose the platform and launch

Which platform

Three real choices, and the honest differences:

	Polsia	NanoCorp	Paperclip
Setup	None	None	Real: a server, a database
Cost to launch	\$20–50/mo + credits	Free trial, then \$30/mo	\$0 + model usage
Fees on sales	3% + 20% on ad spend; \$500/mo withdrawal cap	20% on withdrawals	None
Control	Low; their infra, their agents	Low; full autonomy, no gates	Total; your agents, your rules
Transparency	Live platform stats	Publishes every company's revenue	It is your data
Best for	Fastest hands-off launch	Honest fast experiments	Anyone who wants to own it

For a first weekend: Polsia or NanoCorp. You want speed and you want to spend your attention on customers, not servers. Paperclip is the right second company, once you know the idea works and want to keep the margin and the control. The full trade-offs are in each platform's own guide.

Morning — launch

Paste the brief. Do not press "surprise me"; that button is the platform choosing an idea with no demand signal and it is where the failed companies come from. Let the agents build the site, the product and the payment flow. Read what they produce against the brief. Fix the copy where it stopped sounding like your customers.

Set the caps before anything else: ad budget at zero for the first week, credits at the plan minimum, outreach off unless you have a list of people who asked to hear from you.

Afternoon — the first ten customers, by hand

The agents will offer to run ads and send cold email. Say no for now. Your first ten customers come from the five conversations and the group you found them in. Send the live link personally, with the same three questions you asked yesterday. This is the one part of an AI-run company that a human still does better, and it is the part that decides whether the company lives.

Evening — set the report

Every platform sends a daily summary. Tell the agent what you want in it: visitors, signups, payments, replies, and one question it needs you to answer. Then close the laptop. The point of the weekend was to reach this moment: a real company, a real offer, real people who have seen it, and a machine that will run it while you sleep.

The week after — decide honestly

Give it seven days and one rule: the company earns money or a clear "no" from real people, and either is a good outcome.

- **Two or more paying customers:** double down. Turn on a small ad budget with a hard cap, let the outreach agent contact people who match your first customers, and start a second week.
- **Interest but no payments:** the offer or the price is wrong, not the company. Change one thing, message the interested people, give it seven more days.
- **Nothing:** kill it. Cancel the plan, export what you can, and run the next problem through Saturday. A dead company after one week and \$30 is exactly what this process is for.

Most people who "fail" at AI-run companies never reach this decision. They launch on Sunday, watch the agents work for a month, pay for ads that reach nobody, and quit at \$200. Deciding on day seven is the discipline the platforms cannot give you.

The mistakes that kill weekend companies

Surprise me. The AI picks the idea. Nobody validated it. It builds beautifully and sells nothing.

Ads before customers. Ad spend is where the money goes on every platform and the fee structures reward it. Ten hand-won customers first; ads to find more people like them second.

Trusting the daily report. "Task complete" means the agent thinks it finished. Click the link. Send the test email. Buy your own product once.

Not reading the fees. A \$500 monthly withdrawal cap or a 20% cut changes what "working" means. Know the number before the first sale.

Building the platform, not the feature. Agents will happily add a dashboard, an onboarding flow and an integrations page. Your customer asked for one thing. Ship that.

Waiting. A month of watching is not patience; it is avoidance. Seven days, then a decision.

Glossary

Validation — Confirming real people want a thing before building it. The Saturday of this guide, and the step every platform skips.

Pre-sale test — Offering a product for sale before it exists, to measure demand. A page, a price, a button.

Brief — The one-page document the agents build from: who, problem, offer, price, proof, and what not to do.

Surprise me — The platform option where the AI chooses your business idea. Avoid.

Cap — A hard limit on what an agent may spend: ad budget, credits, outreach volume. Set before launch.

Withdrawal cap / fee — The limit or cut a platform applies when you take out revenue your company earned. Polsia: \$500 a month; NanoCorp: 20%.

Daily report — The summary every platform's agents send. Read it; do not trust it.

Kill — Ending a company that did not sell. Cheap, fast, and the normal outcome of a good process.

This is the how-to. Here are the platforms and the thinking behind them.

GO DEEPER

Get the rest of the series

Every WTF Agents guide is written the same way — plain English, no hype, no jargon. \$7 each, or take a bundle.

Starter Pack \$29

Complete Pack \$49

wtfagents.com →



Scan to browse all guides · wtfagents.com \$7 each · Starter Pack \$29 · Complete Pack \$49 — every guide in the series

WTF is Polsia

The one-person startup that raised \$30M to let AI run your company. What is real, what it costs, and who it is actually for.

wtfagents.com/guides/polsia

How to Hire an AI Agent for Your Business

The practical guide. Pick the task, pick the agent, write the brief, start read-only, measure honestly. No code, no prior AI experience.

wtfagents.com/guides/hire-agent

The Solo Founder's AI Stack

Beyond agents: the voice, video, image, deck, research and automation tools a one-person business runs on. Seven seats, real prices, what to buy first.

wtfagents.com/guides/solo-stack

WTF is the Agentic Economy

The big picture. What actually happened in 2026, who the players are, what is real and what is hype. Start here.

wtfagents.com/guides/agentic-economy

WTF is an AI Agent

What an agent actually is, how it thinks, the main types, real examples, and the risks. The foundation for everything else in the series.

wtfagents.com/guides/ai-agent